

Herald — README

Herald

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Herald

Field	Value
Revision	3
Created	2026-05-15
Last modified	2026-05-20
Status	active
Status summary	Updated spec links to V3 (active) + archive/ for V1/V2; repo-layout block reflects current docs/specs/mvp/ tree.
Issues	none
Issues summary	—
Fixed	spec-path references updated to specification.V3.md path
Fixed summary	aligned README with the V1→V2→V3 supersession chain
Continuation	—

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Ingesting system events and reliably fanning them out to multiple notification channels so every alert reaches the right destination without confusion.

Status

Herald is **pre-implementation** (2026-05-15). The repository currently contains:

- This README.
- The current specification at [docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md](#) — comprehensive (~3900 lines): project-integration contract, inbound processing pipeline, LLM/agent dispatch with Claude Code, tri-stage reply protocol, versioned reports, multi-format outbound attachments, nine refined flavors. V1 and V2 preserved in [docs/specs/mvp/archive/](#) for traceability.
- Project-specific Constitution + operator/agent guides under [docs/guides/](#).
- Mirror declarations at [upstreams/](#) — one shell script per host that exports UPSTREAMABLE_REPOSITORY.
- The inheritance gate + paired mutation meta-test at [tests/](#).
- `.gitignore` tuned for Go (`*.test`, `go.work*`, `coverage.*`) and `.DS_Store`.

There is no `go.mod`, no Go source code, and no build tooling yet. Intended language is Go; standard `cmd/` + `internal/` layout will be used when scaffolding starts.

Mission

Herald sits between systems that **emit events** and humans/services that **want to be told about them**. It guarantees:

- Every event is delivered to every configured channel for its category.
- Duplicate suppression and routing are explicit, not accidental.
- Delivery failures on one channel never block delivery to other channels.

Deployment model

Herald is designed to be consumed as a **git submodule** of a larger project (the “consuming project”). The consuming project provides:

- The **Helix Constitution** submodule at its own <consuming-project>/constitution/.
- Its own CI / build orchestration that drives Herald.
- Any project-wide configuration (credentials, deployment targets, channel registries).

Herald therefore **does not carry its own copy** of the constitution. See [docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md](#) for the full rationale and the discovery contract that lets Herald locate the constitution at runtime from any nested depth.

Governance — Helix Constitution inheritance

Herald inherits unconditionally from the [Helix Universal Constitution](#). Inheritance is enforced by a paired gate + mutation meta-test under `tests/` (see below). Herald-specific extensions live in [docs/guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md](#); there are currently no overrides of any universal clause.

Key invariants Herald inherits from the constitution:

- **No bluffing** — every PASS carries positive evidence (§11.4).
- **Mutation-paired gates** — every new gate has a paired mutation proving it catches regressions (§1.1).
- **No guessing language** — likely, probably, maybe, seems, appears are forbidden when reporting causes (§11.4.6).
- **Credentials never tracked** — `.env` git-ignored, runtime-load only (§11.4.10).
- **Multi-upstream push** — every commit fans out to GitHub + GitLab + GitFlic + GitVerse (§2.1).
- **Hardlinked backup before destructive ops** (§9).

The constitution lives at <https://github.com/HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution> and is mirrored to GitLab, GitFlic, and GitVerse.

Repository layout

```
Herald/
├── README.md                # this file
├── CLAUDE.md                # guidance for
Claude Code agents
├── AGENTS.md                # guidance for
generic CLI agents
├── LICENSE
├── .gitignore
├── docs/
│   └── guides/
│       └── HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md    # Herald's project
constitution (extends Helix)
```

```

|   |   └─ CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md          # operator/agent
guide for the inheritance contract
|   └─ specs/
|       └─ mvp/
|           └─ specification.V3.md                # active spec
(operator-product)
|               └─ archive/
|                   └─ specification.V1.md          # historical,
superseded
|                   └─ specification.V2.md          # historical,
superseded
└─ upstreams/                                     # Herald's mirror
declarations
|   └─ GitHub.sh
|   └─ GitLab.sh
|   └─ GitFlic.sh
|   └─ GitVerse.sh
└─ tests/
    └─ test_constitution_inheritance.sh            # inheritance gate
    └─ test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh      # paired mutation
meta-test (§1.1)

```

Quickstart for developers and agents

1. Place a copy of the Helix Constitution alongside Herald

If you cloned Herald standalone (not as a submodule of a larger project), put a clone of the constitution **next to** Herald (not inside it — see [§104 of the Herald Constitution](#)):

```
git clone git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution.git \
    $(dirname "$PWD")/constitution
```

This is only needed for standalone work. When Herald is consumed as a submodule of a larger project, that project already provides <parent>/constitution/.

2. Verify the inheritance contract

```
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh          # gate (7
invariants)
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh     # paired §1.1
mutation proof
```

Both MUST exit 0. The gate prints PASS ... / FAIL ... per invariant and a summary line. The meta-test prints ✓ META-TEST PASS when the gate correctly fails on a mutated constitution.

If I1 fails (constitution not found), follow the message — clone the constitution alongside Herald.

3. Read the inherited rules

In this order, read fully before submitting any change:

1. <discovered-constitution>/CLAUDE.md + Constitution.md — universal Helix rules.
2. <discovered-constitution>/AGENTS.md — anti-bluff, no-guessing, paired mutations.
3. This README — Herald overview.
4. [CLAUDE.md](#) / [AGENTS.md](#) — Herald-specific guidance.
5. [docs/guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md](#) — Herald's articles §101–§106.
6. [docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md](#) — the discovery contract and gate semantics.
7. [docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md](#) — current spec (active). Historical V1/V2 in [docs/specs/mvp/archive/](#).

Operator setup guides

Every supported messenger and every supported LLM / agent dispatcher has its own step-by-step setup guide under [docs/guides/](#). **Live** ones are detailed end-to-end (obtain credentials → set env vars → verify integration tests → troubleshooting). **Planned** ones are placeholder stubs that reserve the env-var names so your `.env` stays stable as features land.

Messengers

Channel	Status	Guide
Telegram	LIVE (HRD-011 code complete; awaiting live evidence)	docs/guides/messengers/TELEGRAM.md
Slack	Planned (V2)	docs/guides/messengers/SLACK.md
Email (SMTP + Resend)	Planned (V2)	docs/guides/messengers/EMAIL.md
Max	Planned (V2)	docs/guides/messengers/MAX.md
Microsoft Teams	Planned (V3)	docs/guides/messengers/TEAMS.md
Lark / Feishu	Planned (later)	docs/guides/messengers/LARK.md
Discord	Planned (later)	docs/guides/messengers/DISCORD.md
WhatsApp Business	Planned (later)	docs/guides/messengers/WHATSAPP.md
Viber	Planned (later)	docs/guides/messengers/VIBER.md

LLM / agent dispatchers

Dispatcher	Status	Guide
Claude Code	LIVE (HRD-012 Fixed — live E18 evidence captured)	docs/guides/dispatchers/CLAUDE_CODE.md
OpenCode	Planned	docs/guides/dispatchers/OPENCODE.md
Aider	Planned	docs/guides/dispatchers/AIDER.md
Gemini	Planned	docs/guides/dispatchers/GEMINI.md
Cursor	Planned	docs/guides/dispatchers/CURSOR.md
Anthropic Managed Agent	Planned	docs/guides/dispatchers/ANTHROPIC.md

Credentials master guide

[docs/guides/OPERATOR_CREDENTIALS.md](#) is the umbrella reference covering:

- The 12-factor resolution order (CLI flag > shell exports > .env > defaults)
- How to set credentials via ~/.bashrc / ~/.zshrc (shell-export path) AND .env (project-local path) — both supported per spec V3 §3.3
- Pre-commit secrets audit checklist (.env not tracked; no obvious-format secrets; .env.example only has placeholders)
- Quickstart-compose vs native pherald operating modes
- Troubleshooting (SQLSTATE 28P01, “DSN not set”, SKIP-with-reason logic per §11.4.3, ...)

Per Universal Constitution §11.4.10: **.env files MUST NEVER be committed**. The repo’s .gitignore already covers .env. The committed quickstart/.env.example is the only credentials-file that lives in git, and it contains only placeholder values.

Mirror & push convention

Herald is mirrored to four hosts. The origin remote is **fan-out**: one fetch URL + four push URLs. A single git push origin main propagates to every mirror in one operation.

Remote name	URL
github	git@github.com:vasic-digital/Herald.git
gitlab	git@gitlab.com:vasic-digital/herald.git

Remote name	URL
gitflic	git@gitflic.ru:vasic-digital/herald.git
gitverse	git@gitverse.ru:vasic-digital/Herald.git
origin	(fetch from github; push fans out to all four)

Each entry under `upstreams/` is a shell script that exports a single `UPSTREAMABLE_REPOSITORY=...` URL and is meant to be **sourced**, not executed for its output. Capitalization matches each host's brand (GitFlic, GitVerse); do not normalize to lowercase or collapse into one file — external mirror-push tooling keys on the per-file split.

If you ever need to rebuild the fan-out configuration, the constitution submodule ships `install_upstreams.sh` that consumes `Upstreams/*.sh` declarations and configures git remotes accordingly; the same pattern can be adapted for Herald.

License

LICENSE — see file for terms.

Contact / contribution

Substantive contributions land via PRs on GitHub; mirrors are read-only for external consumers. Inheritance rules and the gate apply to every PR.